METRO STATE UNIVERSITY

Our Speakers

MICHAEL SOTO

Data & Analytics Manager, *Integrated Data & Analytics*

Michael Soto (he/him) manages both the IDA Data Science and Data Engineering teams. He is a data scientist with research experience in quantitative and qualitative methods. He has worked in Bangladesh, Chile, China, Colombia, and the UK. He is a co-founder of Spark Collaboration, a startup helping organizations network internally. Michael has published in Demography and Population and Research Policy Review, and has a book chapter, "Serendipity across Contexts." He has a PhD from the University of Minnesota, where he was a fellow at the Interdisciplinary Center for Global Change, an MA from the University of Sussex, and a BA from Harvard University. Michael enjoys playing chess, board games, football, hiking, and canoeing.

CAMERON THIEME

Data Scientist, *Integrated Data & Analytics*

Cameron Thieme (he/him) is a data scientist specializing in mathematical modeling. Prior to joining Hennepin County, he was a researcher at Rutgers University and studied the reliability of machine learning models in a dynamical systems context. Cameron holds a PhD and MS in mathematics from the University of Minnesota and a BS in mathematics from the University of Southern California. His PhD thesis dealt with the mathematical foundations of conceptual climate models. Outside of work, Cameron enjoys playing the guitar as well as biking, weightlifting, camping, and many other active and outdoor hobbies.

Building Insightful Data Pipelines

GBOLADE SHADA

SOFTWARE ENGINEER/ARCHITECT

Gbolade is a software engineer and architect with over 16 years of experience leading the development and architecting of software solutions for financial institutions, including the top-tiered banks in Nigeria and West African countries. He is a Big Data and Information Management expert, spanning 3 years at IBM. He had a brief stint as a technical consultant at the World Health Organization (W.H.O), hosting epidemiological data in the cloud and creating dashboards.